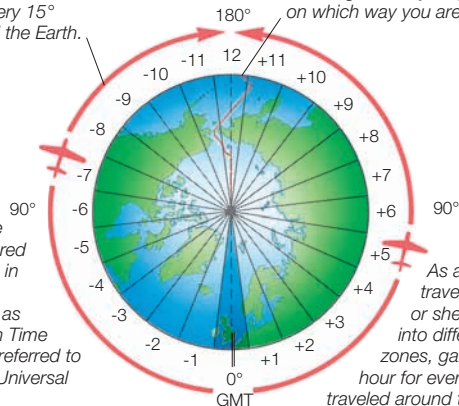


When British naturalist Charles Darwin (1809–1882) went to the Galápagos Islands, off the west coast of South America, he found many unusual creatures, including giant tortoises. He also noticed differences between animals of the same kind living on different islands. This led him to believe that, over many generations, animals change, or evolve, to suit their habitat.

As a person travels west, he or she moves into different time zones, losing one hour for every 15° traveled around the Earth.

Since 1884, time has been measured from Greenwich, in Great Britain. Originally known as Greenwich Mean Time (GMT), it is now referred to as Coordinated Universal Time (UTC).



At the International Date Line, where the date changes, you lose or gain a day, depending on which way you are traveling.

As a person travels east, he or she moves into different time zones, gaining one hour for every 15° traveled around the Earth.

The world is divided into 24 imaginary time zones, shown left, and the time of day changes by one hour from one zone to the next. At a halfway point – the International Date Line – the date changes. The line dissects the Pacific Ocean, although in some places it winds its way between the islands – life would be difficult if it were two different days on one island.

VOLCANOES: 13